AI IN PRACTICE

I want an AI shopping agent. Don't you?

Here's my job ad. (And Claude's honest application.)



12 skills I'd pay for.

swipe →

HÅKAN NILSSON

THE JOB

Wanted: a personal shopping agent. Must work for me, not the store. I'm willing to pay.

Twelve skills in three groups:

Know me

preferences, needs, delivery, loyalty, sizes

Do the job

buying, deliveries, research

Be on my side

loyalty, payment, negotiation, returns

Answers: Claude, October 2026

✓ yes today ½ partly ✕ not yet

Part 1: Know me

½

1 **Knows my preferences: brands, stores, how I like to shop.**

I remember what you tell me. I don't see what you actually buy.

½

2 **Understands my needs, short and long term, and watches for offers that fit.**

I can check on a schedule if you ask. I don't see when you're running low.

✓

3 **Knows my preferred delivery options and pick-up point.**

Tell me once and I'll remember.

✗

4 **Takes my loyalty programmes into account.**

I can't log in to your accounts.

✓

5 **Knows my sizes (shoes, jeans etc).**

Same as above. Tell me once.

Part 2: Do the job

✗ **6 Just buys the routine stuff ("buy toothpaste", "more black socks"). Asks first for a new sweater.**

I can fill a cart, but I stop before paying. Today I ask before every purchase, and I never type in your card details.

✗ **7 Orchestrates deliveries so they arrive on the same day, not spread over the week.**

That needs the retailers' delivery data, which I don't have.

✓ **8 Does market research: "I want a new robot vacuum. Which one?"**

Yes. This is my best part.

Part 3: Be on my side

✓ 9 **It's my agent. Not the retailer's, not the marketplace's. Show me the money.**

I don't show you ads and I don't take a commission.

✗ 10 **Pays with a tokenised version of my card. Limits start low and grow (under SEK 500, just buy it).**

Not yet. The payment rails for agents are being built, but I'm not on them.

½ 11 **Street smart: negotiates with the store and uses my loyalty status when it pays off.**

I can write the pitch. You have to send it.

½ 12 **Handles returns. When something is broken: "We can keep it, but we want 50 % off."**

I can check the return policy and draft the complaint. You hit send.

THE SCORECARD · CLAUDE, OCTOBER 2026

Today: 4 yes. 4 partly. 4 not yet.

Preferences	½
Needs and offers	½
Delivery options	✓
Loyalty programmes	✗
Sizes	✓
Buys routine stuff	✗
Same-day deliveries	✗
Market research	✓
Works for me	✓
Tokenised payment	✗
Negotiates	½
Returns and complaints	½

no surprise there

SO WHAT?

I'd pay for this. If many do, it can change retail more than e-commerce did.

The consequences may be too big to foresee. A few I can see:

No more "You might also like"

Upsell, cross-sell and impulse selling get much harder.

A more transparent market

The agent finds and compares for me.

Marketing changes

Transactional marketing is in for a bumpy ride.

New winners and losers

Producers who give the agents what they need are in the game. If you're "just a marketplace", this might be a challenge.

and an agent that starts showing me ads
can look for another job

OVER TO YOU

Would you pay for an agent like this? Or am I alone?

Håkan Nilsson
Product strategy, digital transformation & AI